

Chapter 177-14

Liang Xinhe went to investigate the trending search matter. He only traced it back to Zhang Yangning, but the name sounded familiar, so he went to discuss it with Liang Xinzhou.

Liang Xinzhou, who had been so busy his feet barely touched the ground, finally had time to look at the trending searches and learned about those matters.

He had sent people to deal with those old photos and videos before.

But clearly, the person who leaked this information had been prepared in advance and even had a complete strategy for stirring up public opinion.

Liang Xinzhou could tell at a glance who had done it.

After Qiu Zimin fell sound asleep, Liang Xinzhou went directly to find Guo Xinran.

At that moment, Guo Xinran had just recovered from a hangover and was lying on the sofa with a headache. When she heard the urgent doorbell, she wanted to smash the door. When she got up to answer it, she was quite irritated.

But the moment she opened the door and saw Liang Xinzhou's cold face, she sobered up on the spot.

"Big Brother, Second Brother." Guo Xinran smiled awkwardly. "Why are you here?"

"To see what you've done." Liang Xinzhou sneered. "Guo Xinran, I warned you—once you entered the entertainment industry, you should just do your own thing, understand? Don't covet any position you can't reach. You're not worthy."

These words were too harsh.

Guo Xinran's face immediately flushed red. "Big... Big Brother, what do you mean?"

Liang Xinzhou looked at her: "You're colluding with Zhang Yangning, aren't you? I thought her losing her job was the final warning for her and you, but you couldn't stay quiet for even half a year before starting again. Yes, the Liang family owes you, but since you came back, no one has mistreated you in the slightest. We gave you a house to live in, cards to spend, and when you wanted to enter the entertainment industry, I paved the way for you. What exactly do you want? Do you want the Liang family, or do you want the Liang family destroyed?!"

Every word was incisive, killing without drawing blood.

Liang Xinzhou had no more patience to deal with her.

Qiu Zimin's health was getting worse by the day. Liang Xinzhou was alone and couldn't handle so many things.

He hadn't seen his son and wife for three days now.

Liang Xinzhou was also about to be crushed by this pressure.

He directly gave Guo Xinran an ultimatum: "I'll give you two choices. One: Take enough money to last you a lifetime and go abroad, or go somewhere none of us can see you. In short, leave Haizhou. Two: Stay in the entertainment industry, but as long as Dongheng is in my hands, I won't help you for a single day. You're completely on your own."

After Liang Xinzhou finished speaking and was about to leave, Guo Xinran grabbed onto the door and suddenly asked loudly: "Why? I'm your real sister, aren't I?"

Liang Xinzhou closed his eyes briefly and sighed with utter exhaustion: "You're too greedy."

Wanting everything.

But her abilities didn't yet match her ambitions.

Liang Xinzhou said: "Your ambitions are written plainly in your eyes, but you don't have the capability yet. When I was fighting my way through the business world, who knows where you were playing around."

Guo Xinran was unconvinced, but then she heard Liang Xinzhou say: "I'll make the decision for you—option one. I'll have someone release your retirement announcement from the industry."

Liang Xinzhou acted quickly, directly having someone release Guo Xinran's retirement announcement. When he returned to the hospital, he found a crowd of people gathered at the door of Qiu Zimin's ward—some he recognized, some he didn't.

Liang Xinzhou immediately went forward and found that the ward was already in complete chaos.

Qiu Zimin was sitting on the hospital bed, extremely weak, but glaring at the person across from her like a venomous snake: "Zhu Mingqi! What exactly makes you better than me? Why does everyone like you?! Yaobo-ge¹, don't you know she's treating you as a substitute?!"

"What nonsense are you spouting?" Zhu Mingqi was furious. "Back then, Shen Chi and I were completely innocent. Shen Chi liking me was her own business—if you have the guts, go yell at Shen Chi. What happened between Shen Yaobo and me was two years after Shen Chi died. How is that being a substitute? Have you been reading too many novels?! Qiu Zimin, I used to genuinely treat you as a friend, as a bestie. Look at what despicable things you've done! Your own daughter went missing, so you bribed my family's servants to steal my daughter. I really..."

Zhu Mingqi was so angry that even the finger pointing at Qiu Zimin was trembling. Her whole body was shaking.

She let out a light breath, but in her fury, she could only manage to say: "You're this sick now! It's your own doing! Serves you right! Scheming all day long, calculating against this person and that person! If you don't get sick, who will?!"

"Enough!" Liang Xinzhou shouted to stop them. He strode to Qiu Zimin's bedside, his tall figure standing between Qiu Zimin and Zhu Mingqi. "Auntie, my mother is not well. If you have anything to say, please say it to me."

"So you're Qiu Zimin's son?" Zhu Mingqi glanced at him. "What do I have to say to you? Move aside."

When Zhu Mingqi argued with Qiu Zimin, it was just like elementary school students.

Zhu Mingqi didn't curse, but she could still provoke Qiu Zimin.

Later, she learned that Qiu Zimin had breast cancer, and it was late-stage—related to her years of pent-up emotions and resentment.

Zhu Mingqi suddenly didn't know how to scold her anymore and could only vent like this.

Though as soon as she entered the ward, she had slapped Qiu Zimin without a word, and only afterward came the elementary school-style argument.

In the past, she could never out-argue Qiu Zimin, but now Qiu Zimin couldn't out-argue her.

Zhu Mingqi couldn't feel happy about it either. After walking out of the hospital, she sat on a bench with Shen Yaobo sitting beside her.

Footnotes:

¹ Yaobo-ge (耀博哥) - "Ge" means "older brother" and is used here as a familiar/affectionate way to address Shen Yaobo. Qiu Zimin using this term suggests she had a close relationship with him in the past, likely through their social circle when they were younger.